Bulletin

Last updated 15-10-2026 at 20:24 — Covering sources published on 15 October 2026

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **PRESS STATEMENT ON AFRICA'S DIGITAL SINGLE MARKET** — Uganda Media Centre (Ministry of Trade, Industry and Cooperatives), 15 October 2026 UGANDA

  Uganda's trade minister issued a statement ahead of a Kampala symposium on building Africa's digital single market, arguing that the country must help shape the rules for cross-border digital trade, payments and delivery. The symposium is set for 22-23 October 2026. *Also under Regional collaboration.*

- **POTRAZ moves to tighten cybersecurity for critical infrastructure** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 15 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Zimbabwe's telecoms regulator is developing a Cybersecurity Framework for Critical Infrastructure Protection, its draft regulation cited as a governance example at a regulators' follow-up meeting in Nairobi. The regulator also restated that data controllers must be licensed under the Cyber and Data Protection Act. *Also under Cybersecurity.*

- **Malatsi wants South Africa's AI policy back on track after false start** — TechCabal, 15 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  One of the two South African officials suspended over the draft national AI policy that cited invented sources has resigned, and disciplinary proceedings continue against the other. The communications minister said cabinet will finalise a replacement before the end of March 2027, with public consultation expected from April. *Also under AI.*

- **Local insurers go solo amid AI policy vacuum** — ITWeb South Africa, 15 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South African insurers are writing their own AI frameworks as they adopt the technology, because the country still has no national AI policy after the draft was withdrawn. The communications department still aims to finalise the policy in the 2026/27 financial year. *Also under AI.*

- **Ghana targets $5bn in annual economic gains from AI – Sam George** — MyJoyOnline, 15 October 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's communications minister said the government has committed US$270 million to its AI plans, US$250 million of it for the first phase of a national AI compute centre and US$20 million for an AI fund, and targets about US$5 billion a year in economic gains. He said the ministry is building a data exchange hub to connect 48 government registries. *Also under AI, Data Storage and Data Exchange.*

- **Ethiopia's New Technology Minister Orders Review of Six Institutions to Advance Digital Agenda** — Tech Africa News, 15 October 2026 ETHIOPIA

Ethiopia's new Minister of Innovation and Technology, appointed on 8 October, told the six institutions under her ministry, among them the technology, communications and intellectual property authorities, to prepare assessments of their operational status, and announced visits to each. *Also under Innovation ecosystem.*

- **Ethiopia launches seventh National Cybersecurity Month to strengthen digital security** — Tech Review Africa, 15 October 2026 ETHIOPIA

  Ethiopia's Information Network Security Administration opened the seventh National Cybersecurity Month, tying national cyber capacity to the Digital Ethiopia 2030 strategy. Its director general warned that attacks on critical infrastructure could trigger social, economic and political crises. *Also under Cybersecurity.*

Legislation and regulation

- **Oral statement under Item 3: The human rights situation in Africa - Southern Africa Litigation Centre** — Southern Africa Litigation Centre, 15 October 2026 SOUTH SUDAN ZAMBIA KENYA NIGERIA AFRICA

  The Southern Africa Litigation Centre told the African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights that the region's decade of striking down sedition, criminal defamation and false-news offences is being reversed, through routine surveillance, new cybercrime laws and prosecutions under them. *Also under Cybersecurity and Data protection.*

Data protection

- **New data body targets 10,000 professionals in Kenya** — TechTrendsKE, 15 October 2026 KENYA

  A Kenya chapter of the Data Management Association launched in Nairobi, planning to train more than 10,000 data professionals over three years with a training partner. It reports more than 900 members and was welcomed by the data protection commissioner's office. *Also under Training and skills and Standards.*

- **Is the Data Protection Act Meant to Protect Citizens, or Censor Freedom of Expression?** — Hanyani News Online, 15 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Panellists at a media policy dialogue in Zimbabwe said the Cyber and Data Protection Act, passed to curb cybercrime and protect women and children online, is being used against journalists. *Also under Public debate and participation in policymaking.*

- **CIPESA Submits Comments to Parliament on Uganda's Digital Number Plate Project** — CIPESA, 15 October 2026 UGANDA

  CIPESA made a submission to the Ugandan Parliament's committee examining the digital number plate project, raising concerns about privacy, surveillance and data protection in the vehicle-tracking system behind it. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Public debate and participation in policymaking.*

- **Ampath downplays data breach claims** — ITWeb South Africa, 15 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South African pathology group Ampath confirmed a cyber attack detected on 2 October that may have exposed patient ID numbers and medical-aid details. It disputes a threat actor's claim of 80 million stolen records, saying the figure counts database entries rather than people, and has notified the Information Regulator. *Also under Cybersecurity.*

- **Accord Sanitaire Sénégal / USA, données personnelles : Pourquoi Sonko fouille le dossier de 54 millards F CFA ? - Xalaat TV** — Xalaat TV, 15 October 2026 SENEGAL

Senegal's National Assembly is to examine the health memorandum signed with the United States on 13 March 2026, over the protection of personal data, under one of five parliamentary inquiries the prime minister announced. The US embassy says Senegal committed to co-invest US$27.3 million in health over five years under the agreement. *Also under US / hyperscaler activities*.

- **Oral statement under Item 3: The human rights situation in Africa - Southern Africa Litigation Centre** — Southern Africa Litigation Centre, 15 October 2026 SOUTH SUDAN ZAMBIA KENYA NIGERIA AFRICA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Regional collaboration

- **Tchad : l'Internet coûte cher, la fracture numérique prospère** — Afro Sync Press Agency, 15 October 2026 CHAD

  A Chadian commentary written during the Central Africa Internet Governance Forum in N'Djamena argues that the cost of getting online, not the official talk of digital sovereignty and AI, decides who takes part in the digital economy. *Also under Digital divides and Access to services*.

- **PRESS STATEMENT ON AFRICA'S DIGITAL SINGLE MARKET** — Uganda Media Centre (Ministry of Trade, Industry and Cooperatives), 15 October 2026 UGANDA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Standards

- **Africa Is Connecting Its Payment Networks. Are We Building One Financial System or Connecting Thirty-Six Different Definitions of Success?** — African Tech Journal, 15 October 2026 AFRICA

  A backend engineer argues that Africa's cross-border payment links are being built before the connected systems agree on how to establish whether a transaction has completed, leaving customers unable to learn where a payment is. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech and Public debate and participation in policymaking*.

- **New data body targets 10,000 professionals in Kenya** — TechTrendsKE, 15 October 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **Building trust in governments through digital platforms** — MIT News, 15 October 2026 KENYA

  Research by the MIT Governance Lab and Busara on a Kenyan county services portal built with a telecoms company found that stressing the company's role made people more willing to use the portal but lowered their trust in government. The study appears in the September issue of Government Information Quarterly. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Digitalisation of sub-national government*.

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Finance

MoUs and other agreements

- **Angola's GGPEN and GEOSAT Partner to Develop Earth Observation Services** — Tech Review Africa, 15 October 2026 ANGOLA

  Angola's national space programme office and the Portuguese company GEOSAT signed a letter of intent on 13 October to cooperate on Earth observation and satellite-data services under the ANGEO-1 programme, for uses ranging from land planning and agriculture to mining and water. *Also under Use of satellite data.*

New investments

- **IFC proposes $35 million loan to WIOCC to expand broadband infrastructure across Africa** — Shore Africa, 15 October 2026 NIGERIA AFRICA

  The IFC disclosed a proposed sustainability-linked loan of up to $35 million to the wholesale operator WIOCC, for more subsea cable capacity, terrestrial fibre in Southern and West Africa and data-centre capacity. Board consideration is projected for 13 November 2026. *Also under Connectivity and Data Storage.*

- **FG, EU, EBRD sign €14m deal to drive 90,000-km fibre-optic backbone project** — BusinessDay Nigeria, 15 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigeria, the European Union and the EBRD signed a EUR 14 million grant for the planned 90,000 km national fibre backbone, funded by the EU and managed by the bank. It pays for scoping, detailed network design, project preparation and capacity-building in the agencies implementing it. *Also under Connectivity.*

- **EBRD supports digitalisation of Nigeria's power distribution network** — European Bank for Reconstruction and Development, 15 October 2026 NIGERIA

  The EBRD agreed financing for Beacon Power Services to extend smart metering and grid-management technology across Nigeria's electricity distribution companies, aimed at cutting losses and improving revenue collection. The sum was not disclosed. *Also under Energy.*

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Telkom Group partners with IEC to power the digital infrastructure behind South Africa's 2026 2026 Local Government Elections** — Lifestyle & Tech, 15 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Telkom announced a R20 million partnership with South Africa's Electoral Commission to provide connectivity and technical support for the 4 November 2026 local government elections, carried on Openserve's national fibre network. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

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- **FG, EU, EBRD sign €14m deal to drive 90,000-km fibre-optic backbone project** — BusinessDay Nigeria, 15 October 2026 NIGERIA

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Data Storage

- **Your AI Pilot Works. But Can You Afford to Scale It?** — Dalberg Data Insights (LinkedIn Pulse), 15 October 2026 RWANDA

  Dalberg Data Insights released a beta toolkit, built with the Rwanda AI Scaling Hub and Gates Foundation support, that estimates what an AI deployment will cost to run as a range across shared, rented and owned inference. The authors argue that costing should start before a pilot ends. *Also under AI.*

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Energy

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Cybersecurity

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DPI

Data Exchange

- **VP: Govt digital platforms 'still not helping the youth'** — The Guardian (Tanzania), 15 October 2026 TANZANIA

Tanzania's Vice President directed the youth and labour ministries to merge the YES youth-enrolment system, the Ajira Portal and the Kazi Portal into one interoperable network, after hearing that YES had registered over 22,000 young people but listed only seven opportunities. He asked for an integration report within a week. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Access to services.*

- **Kang'ata accuses State of putting lives at risk with AfyaKE shutdown** — The Standard, 15 October 2026 KENYA

  Murang'a's governor accused Kenya's national government of switching off the county's AfyaKE digital health system to force it onto another platform, leaving patient records from 2023 inaccessible and services scaled down. Claims the county had uploaded to the Social Health Authority are reported missing. See the health ministry's denial under the same heading. *Also under Sectoral management information systems and Digitalisation of sub-national government.*

- **Ghana targets $5bn in annual economic gains from AI – Sam George** — MyJoyOnline, 15 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **État civil : « 84 % du projet Amecc 2 réalisés »** — Al-Watwan (Comores), 15 October 2026 COMOROS

  The second phase of Comoros's civil-registration modernisation project was reported 84% complete and given three more months at its steering committee, chaired by the interior minister with UNICEF and the French ambassador. Civil-registration centres have been mapped nationwide, the pre-digitisation study finished and new forms designed; France's support is put at EUR 1 million. *Also under Registries.*

- **Can Africa's new CRVS decade close the death registration gap?** — Biometric Update, 15 October 2026 AFRICA

  About one death in ten is registered in Africa, and the 2026-2036 Africa CRVS Decade agreed by civil registrars aims to close that gap by linking civil registration with health and identity systems, widening local registration and digitising records. *Also under Registries.*

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **SSRA Hosts Zambian Delegation on Digital Tax Systems** — Access Radio, 15 October 2026 SOUTH SUDAN ZAMBIA

  A Zambian finance ministry delegation visited the South Sudan Revenue Authority to study its e-Tax, e-Customs and SSCAFFA revenue platforms, which the commissioner general credits with raising monthly collections. The platforms' technical contractor says it does not collect, hold or control government funds. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Africa Is Connecting Its Payment Networks. Are We Building One Financial System or Connecting Thirty-Six Different Definitions of Success?** — African Tech Journal, 15 October 2026 AFRICA

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  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

- **Can Africa's new CRVS decade close the death registration gap?** — Biometric Update, 15 October 2026 AFRICA

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

Sectoral management information systems

- **MoH denies tampering with Murang'a County's health portal** — Citizen Digital, 15 October 2026 KENYA

  Kenya's Ministry of Health denied switching off Murang'a County's AfyaKE electronic medical records system. The health cabinet secretary called the system a private arrangement between the county and its developers and said neither had sought certification from the Digital Health Agency; the county says it has run in 165 facilities since 2023. *Also under Digitalisation of sub-national government.*

- **Kang'ata accuses State of putting lives at risk with AfyaKE shutdown** — The Standard, 15 October 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **Uganda, South Korea Explore Stronger Cooperation in Digital Transformation** — Ministry of ICT and National Guidance (Uganda), 15 October 2026 UGANDA

  Uganda's ICT ministry and the Korea International Cooperation Agency discussed widening their digital-transformation partnership to ICT skills, local innovation and technology in public services. No new agreement or sum was announced. *Also under Training and skills and AI.*

- **INEC Unveils AI Safeguards Ahead of 2027 Elections** — Voice of Nigeria, 15 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigeria's electoral commission has set up an artificial intelligence unit in its ICT directorate to watch for deepfakes and manipulated electoral information before the 2027 general elections. Its chairman said result collation, voter accreditation and candidate qualification will not be fully automated, and that 10 of 14 major milestones under the Electoral Act 2026 are complete. *Also under AI.*

- **Central African Republic's digital public services face connectivity barriers** — Africa Business Insight, 15 October 2026 CAR

  The Central African Republic launched a national portal for online government services on 14 October, covering driving licences, criminal-record extracts, nationality and school certificates, and medical appointments. About 12% of the population used the internet at the end of 2025, which limits who can use it. *Also under Access to services.*

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Digitalisation of sub-national government

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Technology

AI

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Innovation ecosystem

- **African startups raise $2.49B in 9 months as Q3 rebounds** — TechCabal, 15 October 2026 AFRICA

  African startups raised $2.49 billion across 315 disclosed deals in the first nine months of 2026, up 7.8% on the same period of 2025 on fewer deals. The third quarter alone brought in $1.025 billion.

- **Ethiopia's New Technology Minister Orders Review of Six Institutions to Advance Digital Agenda** — Tech Africa News, 15 October 2026 ETHIOPIA

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Capacity

Training and skills

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Access to services

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Data

Use of satellite data

- **Angola's GGPEN and GEOSAT Partner to Develop Earth Observation Services** — Tech Review Africa, 15 October 2026 ANGOLA

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Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

- **Accord Sanitaire Sénégal / USA, données personnelles : Pourquoi Sonko fouille le dossier de 54 millards F CFA ? - Xalaat TV** — Xalaat TV, 15 October 2026 SENEGAL

  Summarised under Data protection.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-15-2**
RETENTION	Kept until 2026-10-22. Older bulletins: the country pages and the monthly reports.
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/bulletin/corpus-bulletin-2026-10-15-2.pdf
FEEDBACK	info@data-landscapers.io
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0

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Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country pages and the monthly reports.